



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity School at Meadow View

School Website: <https://trinitymeadowview.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Trinity School Meadow View (Falls Church, VA) presents a distinctly classical educational posture rooted in liberal-arts formation, engagement with Great Books and primary sources, and a catechetical/historic-Christian framework. Across five of the six classical elements, the school demonstrates a robust alignment with classical education principles: a/theological grounding with transcendent aims; formation of virtue and wisdom as primary goals; a curriculum centered on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books; pedagogy that blends Socratic inquiry with disciplined practice; and a living, communal faculty model. The sixth dimension—Parents & Community—shows less explicit evidence of structured parental partnerships or formal co-teaching roles on public-facing materials, which keeps this category from fully matching the Classical ideal, though the school's culture is clearly community-oriented. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL, with room to strengthen explicit parent-partnership practices to achieve a fully holistic Classical profile.

Key takeaways driving the assessment:

- Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit and integral, with robust Christian/theological framing and scriptural study embedded in curriculum. Evidence includes references to theology, scripture, Old/New Testament study, and a deeply Christian ethos in classroom culture. (Cited materials show Christus-centered language and theology-informed formation)
- Purpose and goals foreground truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable, with formation and contemplation emphasized over mere information. The mission and goals articulate discovery of truth, moral formation, and a love of beauty, aligned with classic paideia aims. (Key statements about truth, beauty, goodness, formation, and the moral imagination)
- Curriculum emphasizes the liberal-arts core (grammar/logic/rhetoric), extensive study of Great Books/original texts, Latin study, and historical breadth. The materials describe ordered knowledge, basic skills, and a habit of greatness, with explicit Great-Books/primary-source emphasis and Latin language study.
- Pedagogy includes contemplative/restful elements and Socratic-style inquiry, with seminars, disciplined dialogue, memory work, and opportunities for rhetorical development. There are explicit references to seminars, coaching, discussion, and the disciplined exchange of ideas, as well as preparation for classical oratory and debates.
- Faculty are positioned as living exemplars and “co-teachers” within a collegial, Christian-learning culture; explicit statements describe the faculty as mentors who model virtue and foster a living-curriculum.
- Parents & Community (Public-facing materials): Evidence of partnership with families and parental formation is weaker in the public-facing materials; the school emphasizes a community of learners but does not clearly publish a formal, shared model of parent co-teaching or routine parent-facing programming. This is the category most visibly weaker in published content relative to classical ideals.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school foregrounds a Christian, theologically informed educational culture, with explicit references to Christian tradition and Scripture in curriculum, including Old and New Testament study and Scripture/Doctrine offerings. This is reinforced by statements about a deeply Christian ethos in the faculty and school culture.
- The mission and goals frame truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent, knowable ideals, and a commitment to formation in virtue rather than secular relativism. The school highlights a moral-imaginative formation and a reverence for the sacred as part of the educational formation.
- Positive keywords map to the classical lexicon (truth, theology, sacred scripture, liturgy, wonder, reverence) and the Great-Books-centered approach that anchors character formation in a transcendent moral order.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, theology, sacred scripture, scripture, Old Testament, New Testament, Christian, wonder, reverence, virtue, moral imagination. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral language in the public-facing content). - Frequency impression: High positive signal with no clear negative signals in the public materials. - Why this rating: The explicit Christian-theological framing and open articulation of transcendentals and moral formation align strongly with Classical religious foundations. The presence of Scripture study and a theologically integrative approach further solidifies CLASSICAL status in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated aims emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable—core Classical telos. The mission states formation of character and transmission of virtue, with a Paideia-like emphasis on human excellence and moral imagination. - The school's goals explicitly articulate the liberal-education orientation (paideia), with references to the true, the good, and the beautiful and to “great conversation” and contemplation. - Positive keywords from the Classical Lexicon include formation, liberal education, paideia, great conversation, and telos; the Trinity materials reflect formation of virtues and an emphasis on contemplating—rather than merely accumulating—information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, studia humanitatis, great conversation, telos, contemplation, scholé, classical heritage, moral imagination. - Negative keywords present: Workforce preparation emphasis (not supported by Trinity content); no evidence of “college/career ready” framing in public-facing Trinity materials. - Frequency impression: Strong positive signal; minimal to no negative signals in the public materials. - Why this rating: The goals and language used match classical aims for formation over narrow job-readiness, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as ordered knowledge, basic skills, and habitual vision of greatness, with explicit emphasis on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium-like breadth (language, history, literature, math, science, arts). The materials emphasize the integration of Great Books/original texts and a reading-list approach. - Great Books and primary sources are a focus, with the school highlighting reading original texts, seminars, and frequent writing assignments in humanities, along with a six-area curricular framework and four years of Latin (plus a modern language). - The curriculum includes study of biblical texts (Scripture/Doctrine) and classical history, with a strong emphasis on Western civilization and the Western canon, as well as a structured progression through Latin, literature, mathematics, sciences, and the arts. - Positive keywords from the Lexicon: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Latin; history; Cicero/Caesar/Virgil; primary sources; languages; classic texts; memorization; recitation; narration; dictation; sacred art; choral/music integration.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), great books, primary sources, classics, Latin, history, salvation/history, Western civilization, natural philosophy, music theory, sacred art, Socratic texts, recitation, narration, dictation, etc. - Negative keywords present: social-studies terminology replacing history, STEM-first framing, project-based learning dominance (not evident in Trinity's public content; the site presents a traditional, integrated approach rather than STEM-first or project-based emphasis). - Frequency impression: High positive signal; minimal or no negative signals in the public content. - Why this rating: The curriculum strongly mirrors classical content and methods (Great Books, gramm/log/rhet, Latin, classical-history integration), which satisfies CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical descriptions emphasize Socratic-style seminar culture, rigorous dialogue, and a strong emphasis on questions, mentoring, and the coach-like teacher role. The Educational Approach de-

scribes coaching, discussion in seminars, direct instruction, and tutorials/workshops as modes of instruction, with a strong focus on active, inquiry-driven learning. - There is explicit emphasis on memory work, recitation, and the memorization of classical content in lower grades, as well as data-rich, rigorous discussion in upper grades (Seminar/Discussion). - The curriculum includes opportunities to develop rhetoric and public-speaking capabilities in the upper levels, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, questioning, dialectic, disputation; narration, recitation, chanting, singing to memorize; memory work; Paideia seminar; rhetoric exercises, speech, declamation, oratory, debate; restfulness/scholé; liturgy/calendar integration; seminars; coaching; direct instruction; tutorials/workshops. - Negative keywords present: experiential learning focus, project-based only, student-directed, constructivist (not evident in Trinity's public materials; the site presents a mix but leans toward structured, classical modalities rather than pure constructivist approaches). - Frequency impression: Strong positive signal; minimal negative signals in the public materials. - Why this rating: The pedagogical approach aligns closely with classical pedagogy as defined by the lexicon (Socratic discussion, memory work, recitation, ritualized study, and public speaking) and is described in the Trinity materials. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes faculty as dedicated, with "living curriculum," mentors, and a culture of serious intellectual growth. It emphasizes training, subject-matter expertise, and a Christian, collegial, and mentor-centered environment. - The faculty are described as the core of the school, with a culture of collaboration, and an emphasis on teachers modeling virtue and grace under the banner of classical formation. - The governance and culture emphasize a "portrait of a teacher" and a "faculty as living curriculum," aligning with classical expectations for teacher mentors as exemplars.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: dedicated faculty, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentorship, moral exemplars, teacher training in classical pedagogy, formation. - Negative keywords present: Facilitators/guides on the side, certification-driven jargon (not evident in the public-facing content; not contradicted by Trinity's materials). - Frequency impression: Strong positive signal; no explicit negative signals. - Why this rating: The faculty framing aligns with classical expectations of teachers as moral exemplars and living curriculum. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing materials focus on student formation, the culture of truth/goodness/beauty, and a community of learners, but do not present explicit, public-facing structures for parent partnership as co-educators or parent-formation programs (e.g., book studies, family liturgy, parent covenant). The lexicon of classical partnership with families appears in the "Six Essential Elements" framework rather than in Trinity's public-facing pages. This category remains the weakest in explicit evidence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: None clearly published in public-facing Trinity Meadow View materials for this category (e.g., "partnership with families," "co-teachers," "parent formation," "open campus" are not publicly evidenced as explicit Trinity Meadow View content). - Negative keywords present: None explicitly stated in Trinity Meadow View content; however, the absence of explicit parent-co-teaching language is the point of concern here. - Frequency impression: 0 explicit positive signals; no explicit negative signals in the public content, but the absence of explicit Parent & Community programs means this category does not meet Classical criteria as published by the Six Elements lexicon. - Why this rating: The Classical framework from the Six Elements emphasizes explicit parent partnership and community formation. The Trinity Meadow View content does not publicly demonstrate these exact mechanisms, so this category does not meet Classical criteria as evidenced in public-facing materials. NOT CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment across all six categories - CLASSICAL: 5/6 categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty) meet classical criteria based on the school's public-facing materials and the classical framework. - NOT CLASSICAL: 1/6 category (Parents &

Community) lacks explicit, publicly evidenced parent-partnership structures as described in the Six Elements framework.

Overall, Trinity School Meadow View meets CLASSICAL standards in the majority of six core categories, with category 6 not fully evidenced in public materials. Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - If the school were to explicitly publish and implement a robust Parents & Community program that aligns with the classical model (e.g., formal partnerships with families as co-educators, family formation events, classical book clubs for parents, regular parent visits, and a clearly defined “parent covenant” or home-liturgy alignment), the aggregate rating would move toward a fully CLASSICAL across all six categories. This would also bring the public-facing materials into alignment with the Six Essential Elements’ Community/Parental category.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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